immediate future of the coin is that it is equally likely to be heads or tails, even though there is some definite thing it will be."

It's still not obvious that basing probability on our knowledge rather than on frequencies is really a step forward. Many-Worlds is a deterministic theory, and if we know the wave function at one time and the Schrödinger equation, we can figure out everything that's going to happen. In what sense is there anything that we don't know, to which we can assign a credence given by the Born rule?

There's an answer that is tempting but wrong: that we don't know "which world we will end up in." This is wrong because it implicitly relies on a notion of personal identity that simply isn't applicable in a quantum universe.

What we're up against here is what philosophers call our "folk" understanding of the world around us, and the very different view that is suggested by modern science. The scientific view should ultimately account for our everyday experiences. But we have no right to expect that the concepts and categories that have arisen over the course of pre-scientific history should maintain their validity as part of our most comprehensive picture of the physical world. A good scientific theory should be compatible with our experience, but it might speak an entirely different language. The ideas we readily deploy in our day-to-day lives emerge as useful approximations of certain aspects of a more complete story.

A chair isn't an object that partakes of a Platonic essence of chairness; it's a collection of atoms arranged in a certain configuration that makes it sensible for us to include it in the category "chair." We have no trouble recognizing that the boundaries of this category are somewhat fuzzy—does a sofa count? What about a barstool? If we take something that is indubitably a chair, and remove atoms from it one by one, it gradually becomes less and less chairlike, but there's no hard-and-fast threshold that it crosses to jump suddenly from chair to non-chair. And that's okay. We have no trouble accepting this looseness in our everyday speech.

When it comes to the notion of "self," however, we're a little more protective. In our everyday experience, there's nothing very fuzzy about our self. We grow and learn, our body ages, and we interact with the world in a variety of ways. But at any one moment I have no trouble identifying a specific person that is undeniably "myself."